NEVER FIGHT OR ARGUE AGAIN

The Safety Plan

For the one who was hurt: seven steps to walk before you speak.

① Pray First

Seek God before you speak. Ask the Holy Spirit for wisdom before you address the issue.

"If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God..." **James 1:5**

② Follow SCIP

Sit down. Calm down. Identify. Process. Slow your emotions down before you speak.

"Hasty feet miss the way." **Proverbs 19:2**

③ Talk to a Safe Person

Get wise counsel before confrontation. A trusted voice helps you see clearly.

"Victory is won through many advisers." **Proverbs 11:14**

④ Consider the Circumstances

Check yourself first. Am I tired? Am I stressed? Did I misunderstand? Is there more to the story?

"Let us examine our ways..." **Lamentations 3:40**

⑤ Become Emotionally Neutral

No anger. No reaction. Just control. You cannot resolve conflict while you are emotionally charged.

"Quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry." **James 1:19**

⑥ Prepare a Solution

Bring solutions, not just problems. Think through what a healthy resolution would actually look like.

"The plans of the diligent lead to profit..." **Proverbs 21:5**

⑦ Choose the Right Time

Timing matters more than you think. The right words at the wrong time still fail.

"There is a time for everything..." **Ecclesiastes 3:1**

THE FINAL RULE

Do Not Engage

Unless you are prepared. Rushing into conflict creates damage, not resolution.

"To answer before listening, that is folly." **Proverbs 18:13**

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L.U.V. Your Spouse Through Conflict

A Spirit-led way to respond after your spouse shares pain. It shifts the focus from resolution to reconnection.

Not to explain, defend, or apologize fast to make it end. Your spouse is looking for **recognition**.

L — Listen · Deeply, actively, without judgment

Let go of the urge to correct, interpret, judge, or plan your response.

DO IT: Track pain, tone, history, and heart. Stay engaged. Don't filter their words through guilt, defensiveness, or pride. **Drive-Through:** reflect what you heard before you offer anything else.

"What I hear you saying is that when I said that in front of our friends, you felt embarrassed and dismissed."

"Quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry." **James 1:19**

U — Understand · With empathy

Understanding is not the same as agreement.

DO IT: Pause internally. Imagine their experience: what message did they receive from my words or actions? Speak your understanding.

"I can understand why that moment hit you that way. That would have felt lonely."

"...each of you to the interests of the others." **Philippians 2:4**

V — Validate · The concern is legitimate

Not agreeing with every conclusion. Honoring that the feeling was real.

DO IT: "Your emotions make sense." "You're not being too sensitive." "I can see why it felt that way."

"You're right to feel hurt. I can see that now, and I respect you for saying something."

"To answer before listening, that is folly and shame." **Proverbs 18:13**

FIRST, ALWAYS: Before apology, before solution, before reconciliation, comes LUV.

WHEN TO USE IT: As your default posture when your spouse shares anything vulnerable.

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The Stop-Loss Strategy

Protect the conversation before it becomes destructive.

WHERE THE CONVERSATION IS HEADING

SAFE	THE PINCH	IT HITS DEEPER	EMOTION TAKES OVER	CALL IT HERE	HARM
	a comment, a tone, a look	old hurt, insecurity, fear	behavior follows emotion		*what you never have to take back*

YOUR STOP-LOSS: THE LINE YOU AGREED ON

You never go from calm to conflict in one step. You go from pinch, to emotion, to reaction. The stop-loss exists to interrupt that chain, while you still have something worth protecting. *"Above all else, guard your heart...."* **PROVERBS 4:23**

CALL IT THE MOMENT ANY ONE OF THESE APPEARS

- **Emotional escalation.** Raised voices. Sarcasm or harsh tone. Interrupting. Reacting instead of listening.
- **Loss of control.** You feel flooded. You are no longer thinking clearly. You are rehearsing your defense.
- **Disrespect.** Name-calling. Dragging up the past. Blame-shifting. Eye-rolling or shutting down.
- **Process breakdown.** SCIP is gone. No listening or validating. The same point, repeated, going nowhere.

HOW TO CALL IT

"I'm feeling overwhelmed. I need to call a stop-loss."

"I want to do this right, but I need a reset."

"I care about this too much to keep going like this."

Pre-agreed. Honored immediately. No arguing about it, no chasing, no continuing the discussion.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

1. **Pause.** Stop talking immediately. No last word.
2. **Separate.** Different rooms or space. Reduce the stimulation.
3. **Regulate.** Sit down. Calm down. Identify what you feel. Process it.
4. **Do not rehearse.** No comebacks. No building your case. Calm and clarity, not winning.

HOW LONG TO STEP AWAY

MINIMUM	20–30 MINUTES	What your body needs to calm down physiologically.
RECOMMENDED	30–60 MINUTES	Enough time for a full emotional reset.
MAXIMUM	24 HOURS	Never leave the issue unresolved beyond a day.

Set the return time before you leave. Come back to the process, not to the conflict: open softly, listen first, and check that you are both ready.

THE STOP-LOSS AGREEMENT: WE AGREE TO

Call it when either of us needs it. **Honor it** immediately, with no resistance. **Return** at the time we agreed on. **Restart** with the process, not the emotion.

"Stopping the conversation doesn't mean failure.
It means you care enough to do it right."
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The Anti-Fight Plan

A roadmap for non-combative conflict resolution: the communication steps that reach resolution.

1 THE ONE WHO WAS HURT · 2 MIN

Open in Love

Speak gently. Name what you felt, with respect and kindness. No "always," no "never."

"Speaking the truth in love." **Ephesians 4:15**

2 THE ONE WHO CAUSED IT

Respond with L.U.V.

Listen · Understand · Validate. Reflect back what you heard before you say anything else.

"Be quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry." **James 1:19**

3 THE ONE WHO CAUSED IT · 2 MIN

Answer in Love

Share your heart. Take responsibility. No defense, no explaining your intent.

"A gentle answer turns away wrath." **Proverbs 15:1**

4 THE ONE WHO WAS HURT

Respond with L.U.V.

Listen · Understand · Validate. The same posture, now in the other direction.

"Bear with each other and forgive one another." **Colossians 3:13**

NOW THE LANES MERGE, TOGETHER

5 **Bring the Solution**

The one who was hurt introduces the solution they prepared. Discuss others if they are needed.

"As far as it depends on you, live at peace with everyone." **Romans 12:18**

6 **Agree and Commit**

Agree to work toward the solution. Leave united and committed to grow, not merely finished.

"A cord of three strands is not quickly broken." **Ecclesiastes 4:12**

LOVE | RESPECT | TEAMWORK

"Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called children of God." **Matthew 5:9**

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